Now that you are able to add users and tasks to nodetodo, wouldn’t it be nice if you could retrieve all this data?

12.4 Retrieving data

So far, you have learned how to insert users and tasks into two different DynamoDB tables. Next, you will learn how to query the data, for example, to get a list of all tasks assigned to Emma.

DynamoDB is a key-value store. The key is usually the only way to retrieve data from such a store. When designing a data model for DynamoDB, you must be aware of that limitation when you create tables (as you did in section 12.2). If you can use only the key to look up data, you’ll sooner or later experience difficulties. Luckily, DynamoDB provides two other ways to look up items: a secondary index lookup and the scan operation. You’ll start by retrieving data by the items’ primary key and continue with more sophisticated methods of data retrieval.

DynamoDB Streams

DynamoDB lets you retrieve changes to a table as soon as they’re made. A Stream provides all write (create, update, delete) operations to your table items. The order is consistent within a partition key. DynamoDB Streams also help with the following:

- If your application polls the database for changes, DynamoDB Streams solves the problem in a more elegant way.
- If you want to populate a cache with the changes made to a table, DynamoDB Streams can help.